IT and Information Security Policy

Mandatory for employees, contractors and interns | Owner: Office of the CTO | Version 3.1, effective 1 May 2026

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1. Scope

This policy covers all company laptops, phones, cloud accounts, source code, customer data and any personal device used to access MFT systems. Violations are treated as misconduct under the HR handbook.

2. Data Classification

Level	Examples	Handling rule
Public	Website content, marketing brochures	No restriction
Internal	Org charts, internal wikis, meeting notes	Share only within MFT
Confidential	Customer contracts, pricing quotes, product roadmap	Share on need-to-know basis; encrypted storage
Restricted	Driver personal data, GPS history of customers, credentials, encryption keys	Access logged; approval of data owner and security team required

3. Accounts and Passwords

- Passwords must have at least **14 characters** and must be changed only when compromise is suspected.
- **Multi-factor authentication (MFA)** is compulsory for email, VPN, source-code repositories and cloud consoles. SMS codes are not accepted for admin accounts; use an authenticator app or a hardware key.
- Sharing passwords is prohibited. Teams must use the company password manager.
- Access reviews are run every **90 days**; managers must confirm or remove each team member's access within 7 days of the request.

4. Devices

- All laptops use full-disk encryption and automatic screen lock after **5 minutes** of inactivity.
- USB storage devices are blocked by default. Exceptions need written approval from the IT security team and last for a maximum of 30 days.
- Personal phones may access email only through the managed work profile.
- A lost or stolen device must be reported within **2 hours** to the IT helpdesk (it@meridianfreight.example) so that it can be remotely wiped.

5. Use of AI Tools

Employees may use approved AI assistants for drafting, coding help and summarising public information. The following are **never** to be pasted into public or unapproved AI tools: customer names and contracts, driver personal details, GPS or trip data, source code of FleetPulse or RouteMind, and anything classified Confidential or Restricted. AI-generated code must go through the normal code-review process.

6. Customer Data and Cloud

- Production customer data stays in the Mumbai and Singapore cloud regions only. Customers in the UAE may request storage in the Dubai region.
- Developers do not have standing access to production databases. Temporary access is granted through a break-glass request that expires after **4 hours** and is fully logged.
- Backups run daily and are retained for **35 days**; encrypted backups are tested for restoration every quarter.

7. Security Incident Response

Severity	Description	Report within	Response lead
SEV-1	Confirmed data breach or full outage of customer systems	15 minutes	CTO and Security Lead
SEV-2	Suspected breach, ransomware alert, partial outage	1 hour	Security Lead
SEV-3	Phishing click, policy violation without data loss	4 hours	IT Security team
SEV-4	Minor event, no customer impact	1 working day	IT helpdesk

Affected customers are notified within **72 hours** of a confirmed breach involving their data, in line with contractual and regulatory duties. A post-incident review is published internally within 10 working days.

8. Training

New joiners complete security awareness training in their first 2 weeks. All employees repeat it every year and take part in a phishing simulation each quarter. Employees who fail three simulations in a year must attend a mandatory refresher session.